

145 Banking and Finance

Description & Eligibility

Contestants will analyze banking and credit principles, evaluate financial services, and apply secure practices for transactions, account management, and compliance with regulations. Any secondary or postsecondary division contestant may enter this application event.

Contestant Must Supply

- Published and/or unpublished non-electronic written reference materials
- Sharpened pencils, pens, ruler
- Cordless calculator: Electronic devices will be monitored according to ACT standards. See NLC Calculator Guidelines. Contestants who violate this rule will be *disqualified*.

Equipment/Supplies Provided

- Computer and software

Competition Notes

- Method of evaluation: objective | application
- AI Policy Level 1 *No AI Allowed*
- No equipment, supplies, or materials other than those specified for an event will be allowed in the testing area
- Previous Business Professionals of America tests and/or sample tests or facsimiles (handwritten, photocopied or keyed) may not be taken into the testing area. Violation of this rule will result in disqualification.
- Length of event: no more than ten (10) minutes for orientation, no more than sixty (60) minutes for testing, and no more than ten (10) minutes for wrap-up
- Entries vary by state

Contest Competencies

1. Analyze factors affecting credit choices, including credit scoring, costs of credit, and cybersecurity, and describe types of loans and application processes
2. Analyze the functions of commercial paper, secured transactions, and bankruptcy
3. Identify and distinguish the evolving functions and services of traditional banks, online banks, and financial institutions
4. Develop and implement strategies for secure cash handling and fraud and identity theft prevention
5. Describe the FDIC's evolving role in the banking industry
6. Describe procedures for electronic banking including mobile apps, biometric authentication, and real-time payments
7. Define and perform steps to open, maintain, and reconcile checking accounts using traditional and online platforms
8. Define and calculate both simple and compound interest
9. Describe the advantages and disadvantages of traditional digital savings and investment platforms in the banking industry
10. Identify government regulations in banking including compliance with digital finance laws and data protection
11. Explain the fundamentals of cryptocurrency and blockchain technology
12. Describe the custody, storage, and risk of digital assets, and associated security considerations
13. Evaluate ethical considerations and consumer protection in modern banking
14. Explain the types and functions of digital currencies, including cryptocurrency and stablecoins

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